

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a website:

Chindōgu: Weird and Useless Japanese Inventions

The Japanese term Chindōgu (literally 'unusual tool') describes any invention which is so strange that you forget about its actual usefulness. So popular was this idea that Kenji Kawakami, who coined the term, founded the international Chindōgu Society. Defining a particular gadget as Chindōgu-worthy is harder than it looks. The Chindōgu Society dictates several core rules which must apply to the said invention. It must be useless and it must be real and not just a concept. Furthermore, a Chindōgu should be designed for daily use.



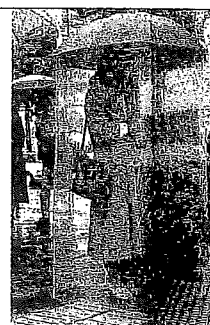
The Baby Mop

Too much work to do around the house? Got a kid or two to keep an eye on? This gadget lets users keep track of their kids and get on with cleaning up!



Chopstick Noodle Cooler

Nice and simple – attach the mini-fan to your chopsticks and start eating – your food will never be too hot again!



Full Body Umbrella

Getting wet because of a small umbrella is now a thing of the past. Behold, the Full Body Umbrella, an umbrella conjoined with a lengthy plastic sheet.

Your school is holding a Society Day to introduce clubs to students. Your group wants to set up a Chindōgu Society. You may want to talk about:

- what the aims of your society will be
- what will make your society different from the other clubs
- which of the above inventions you would use to promote your society
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Which of the three inventions in the photographs do you like the most?
2. Would you like to be an inventor?
3. Why do you think some people are interested in these inventions?
4. Do you think younger people or older people would be more interested in these inventions?
5. Would people in Hong Kong use these inventions if they were promoted here?
6. How could schools in Hong Kong encourage creativity in their students?
7. Is it easy to be an inventor?
8. Which invention do you wish had never been invented?